

iCamp

From finding options to trusting one enough to book.



CONTEXT

Self-initiated

DURATION

3 weeks

ROLE

Solo design

STATUS

Validated
Not shipped

Campers can find places to camp.

The problem starts when they *need to decide* which one to trust.

How structured information can reduce uncertainty and help people make more confident travel decisions.

Finding isn't the problem. Trusting is.

Camping is becoming a more common way to disconnect, but planning a trip is still fragmented and manual.

Insight: *Choosing the wrong campsite can affect the entire trip.
So the problem changed from:*

“improving search” to “supporting more confident decisions.”

Mixed methods + the user with the highest stakes.

EVIDENCE

Survey (n=140) + 5 in-depth interviews.

51% Report difficulty finding new campsites

45% Rely on Facebook for discovery

#1 Lack of reliable info — most cited frustration

THE INSIGHT THAT BECAME THE BRIEF

Search → validate → hesitate → search.

Users get stuck in the loop instead of moving forward.

Primary User — Decision Context



Richard, 39

Family-oriented camper

Camps with his wife and young daughter and values safe, well-planned trips.

Context

- Lives in São Paulo and uses camping as a way to disconnect from routine and spend time in nature.
- Because he usually travels with family, choosing a campsite is less about spontaneity and more about trust, structure, and predictability.

Behaviors

- Discovers campsites through Facebook, Google, and camping communities
- Cross-checks multiple sources before deciding
- Plans around route, infrastructure, and nearby services

Friction Points

- Information is scattered and inconsistent
- Important details are often missing
- Contacting campsite owners is slow or unreliable

Core Need

🍏 I need to be sure this place is safe and suitable for my family before I commit.

Success Looks Like

Being able to **quickly evaluate** a campsite, **trust the information**, and complete the booking without uncertainty.

Richard represents a broader behavior pattern; people are willing to **explore**, but they **need enough reliable information** to feel confident before booking.

Richard represents a broader behavior pattern; people are not just looking for new places but may need enough **reliable information** to feel confident before booking.

Designed for Richard — family camper. Demanding criteria pull the bar up for everyone.

The app should absorb the bureaucracy of the trip.

Campers don't want to plan more.
They want to plan less and enjoy more.

Insight from testing

iCamp should not be just a campsite catalog, but a layer that simplifies travel decisions.agem.

Less bureaucracy. More camping.

Compete on the quality of decisions. Not on the number of features.

PRIORITIZED

Structured information

Standardized attributes make comparison faster and more reliable.

DEPRIORITIZED

Community

Profiles, follows, and UGC can drive engagement, but they don't solve initial trust.

WHY

Trust before engagement

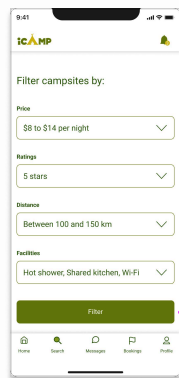
Camping is an infrequent decision with a high perceived risk.

TRADE-OFF

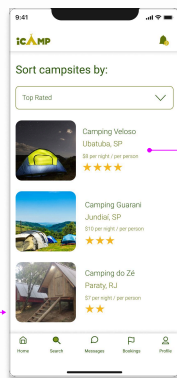
Community can come later — first, the information needs to prove its value.

Search → Campsite → Booking, in one flow.

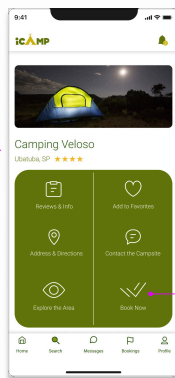
Profiles lead with what campers actually decide on: photos, structured details, and reviews as decision-relevant signals.



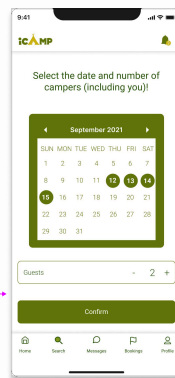
Filters



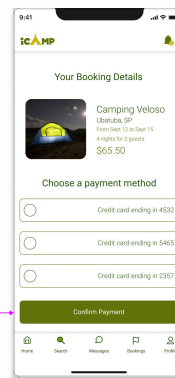
Results



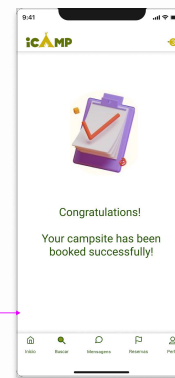
Campsite



Select Date



Payment



Confirmation

What I got wrong on the first pass.

WHAT I DESIGNED FIRST

~15 Filter dimensions

Every filter users mentioned. The theory: more control equals better decisions.

WHAT I IMPROVED AFTER TESTING

4 primary filters, rest progressive

Participants used three or four. The rest created cognitive load before they'd seen a campsite.

THE TAKEAWAY

Completeness is a designer's instinct — not a user need.

Measure the decision. Learn before scaling.

HOW I WOULD MEASURE IT

PRIMARY METRIC

Time to decision

Search → booking.

SECONDARY METRIC

Validation outside the app

How many users leave the app to confirm information.

COUNTER-METRIC

Booking regret

More information should not create false confidence.

WHAT THIS TAUGHT ME

Completing the interface does not mean completing the decision.

Fewer filters can mean more confidence.

WHAT I WOULD REVISIT

- Test with a larger sample.
- Better validate the decision not to prioritize community.
- Prototype with campsite owners.

EXPLORE THE PROTOTYPE

[Figma prototype link](#)

Thank you for reading.